

Mac not for gamers

Valve reports lower performance of games on Mac machines, awhile back they had launched games for Mac on Steam

Corsair's affordable SSD

Corsair's Nova series are aimed at value users. The cheapest one is only 69 US\$

it fits the palm slightly more securely.

Rs. 6,295 is a lot of dough to shell out for a mouse – the G9x brings a lot of features to the table however, and is a very useful productivity tool courtesy its ratchet scroll and side scrolling. Still, gamers who want bling have a large hunk of plastic that is passable looking at best.

Microsoft Sidewinder X5

At first glance the X5 looks like it was modelled after the batmobile. It's a mixture of curves and sharp angles, and when the twin lights that shine from recesses in the rear looks nice. The mouse feels much larger in hand than other mice, though is not uncomfortable for it. Quite the contrary, it feels substantial in-hand, although the slightly bulging rear can be felt in the centre of the palm, no matter how large your palm – this is something you'll have to adjust to. The sides of the mouse feature sharp recesses, but your fingers won't encounter these. There is a small LCD that displays the current dpi reading and a row of three buttons on the top, just behind the scroll wheel allow selecting between 400, 800 and 2,000 dpi. The visual indicator of the current dpi is a nice touch – kudos

to Microsoft for including it, other mice have a series of LEDs that illuminate in sequence – this isn't as intuitive. On the right side is the weight tray, it can hold up to three weights, and Microsoft provides six, three each of five and ten grams.

Surprisingly, the mouse doesn't handle very differently without/with weights. The extra buttons on the left side look like two round metal protrusions but are actually very comfortable to use. Being vertically stacked, they're actually (arguably) easier to use than the other horizontally stacked buttons. Your thumb is a little more comfortable when using these. Although large, the X5 is comfortable, and your right hand's ring finger will sit comfortably in the groove on the right side of the mouse. The thumb recess is smaller, but comfortable. The feet, that are Teflon, are little more than small discs with pegs that insert into the body of the mouse. You get three sets of feet – white, black and grey.

The X5 is pretty accurate and tracks well on the Destructor, but the slightly harder feet mean that it's better off being used on cloth-based surfaces. The Destructor's sur-



Microsoft Sidewinder X5

face feels a little abrasive for the X5, while on the Titan mat things are butter-smooth. Also on the substantial feeling of the mouse in-hand, gives a strange feeling of satisfaction, despite the slight bulge at the rear. Your fingers are completely stretched out on the mouse buttons and that feels pretty comfortable. At Rs. 3,184, the Sidewinder X5 is reasonably priced for the features it offers, although it's not the last word in terms of pin point accuracy – ultimately it vies with the G5, whichever way you go – you won't regret either.

Logitech G5

The new G5 features two thumb buttons instead of one, and has a matte finish on the body that is sweat and slip resistant. The G5 has a catchy design on the body and the mouse itself is very well contoured to fit right-handed people. In fact, the grip and shape is better than the G9/G9x, and the deep thumb recess is very comfortable. The only problem is that there is no contour for the right-hand ring finger and this finger will languish in the near vicinity of the right click. If you place your ring finger in the recess, your last finger will touch the mousepad surface.

The buttons have a very positive feedback. The thumb buttons are located ergonomically but this isn't as good as the vertical stack on the Microsoft Sidewinder X5. There is a small

backlit indicator for the current dpi setting. The scroll wheel has tilt functionality and this works perfectly, not once did we accidentally click the mouse wheel while side scrolling. The G5 has the DPI change buttons beneath the scroll wheel, the MX518 had them in a one up, one down position. The G5 also misses the document flip button than the MX518 has – we wonder why Logitech digressed here.

Large feet give the G5 a very precise feel on nearly both our mats. The G5 feels right at home on the Destructor – and tracking is very accurate, at 800 dpi (which many gamers use), you will not notice a difference between this and the Logitech G9x or Razer Mamba. Due to the higher acceleration, initially one might feel the G5 to over track slightly, but once you get used to the extra glide, things settle down. On the Titan mat, the G5 feels accurate and precise, but with slightly less acceleration than on the Destructor, obviously the cloth on the Titan providing more purchase. The mouse has a nice weight that feels just right, a weight tray is provided with additional weights – the G5 allows finer tuning than the G9x, as the weights are 1.7 and 4.5 grams. Even fully loaded the G5 doesn't feel very heavy.



Logitech G5

HOW WE TESTED

We used the Razer Destructor and Everglide Titan gaming mats to check all the mice. The PC used to check these mice consisted of a Core 2 Duo Q9650 CPU, ZOTAC GTX 285 graphic card and 4 GB of OCZ RAM. A display with a resolution of 1680 x 1050 pixels was used. Besides features and ergonomics, we tested these mice for comfort and customisability. For the test, we used two

games – *Quake III Arena* and *Warcraft 3: The Frozen Throne*. The first is one of the quickest first person shooters around and the second is one of the most fast paced real time strategy games you will see. We tested the mice for accuracy, speed and glide on different surfaces. Acceleration, response, negative acceleration and over tracking were all considered for accuracy and a final rating was given.